

leave a bad impression on customers. Additional fallout of the distance problem is that of finding good service personnel in remote locations. Sometimes, the hired engineers are not experienced enough to handle problems, “For LG monitors, we had a service centre at Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, but they do not service well. They take a month’s

time to service a monitor,” complains Philip George, a computer programmer. He goes on to plead: “Please provide the service centres with personnel who know their job well.”
Apart from these niggles, there are

requests for better software drivers—be it for alternative operating systems (especially Linux), or for avenues of entertainment and education (“display drivers should be advanced for gamers and Internet browsers”).

MOST RELIABLE DISPLAYS: Samsung RUNNER-UP: LG Electronics
MOST SATISFACTORY SERVICE: Samsung RUNNER-UP: LG Electronics

Hard Disks

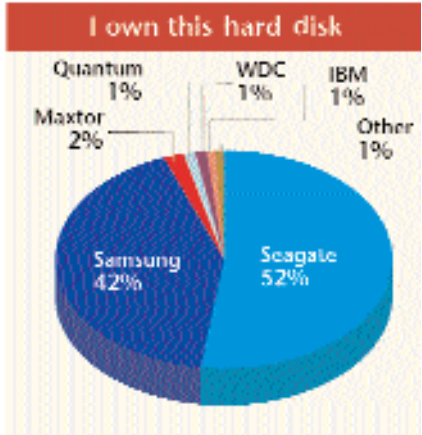
The mirror-smooth, dust-free disc travels at a speed of around 272 Kph. Not far, at a distance of 0.3 micronmeter—a typical human hair is 57 times as thick—flies an aluminium arm, moving from the centre of the glass-like surface to its hub up to 50 times per second. Want an analogy? Imagine a Boeing 747 airplane six inches above the ground. Behold the hard disk, a marvel of small-scale mechanics, nestling within your computer, laptop or MP3 player.

For us consumers, such numbers mean little. The marvel is lost with a crash or a bad sector; all that data gone! Not surprisingly, our reader feedback pertaining to this particular category evoked a lot of frustration, obviously... Data loss is never appreciated. Within this segment, two players emerged leaders—



Samsung and Seagate. Of the total 1,202 votes on hard disks, Samsung bagged 508 and Seagate 631, leaving others with less than five per cent of votes and forcing us to nudge them out of the survey analysis. Of the two, Samsung emerged the better choice, earning higher numbers for both customer satisfaction with its service, and for the reliability of its hard disk.

Winner for hard disks is **SAMSUNG**

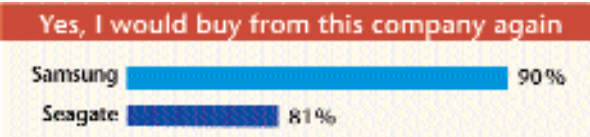


Cause of Bad Sectors

Hard disks are extremely sensitive to shock (approximately 30 per cent of hard disk failure is shock-induced). Hard disks without a home (a PC, for example), are very vulnerable as they are exposed to external shocks—as many as several hundred G-force per millisecond—incurred by mishandling, installation, etc. As the storage capacity of a hard disk’s platters increases, so does the likelihood of collision between the disk and head, since they come closer with an increase in capacity. Even the slightest of shock is capable of damaging a hard disk: small shocks may travel to the core and cause a head slap (where the head of a hard disk, physically hits the platter’s surface). When this collision occurs, particles form on the disc’s surface and accumulate with time, creating friction with the head, thus increasing the temperature of the disc. This increased heat causes read and write errors, formation of bad sectors and data loss.

Seagate’s after-sales service is very bad. Also it [hard disk] gives lots of problems

Deepak, on Seagate hard disks
Ambala, Haryana



One of the most important factors in Samsung’s favour is the warranty period it offers on its hard disks: all three years worth of it, as opposed to Seagate’s one-year period. Time and again, readers pointed this out as a favourable number, secure in the fact that their data is as safe as it can be for at